Weather Spotter Quick Reference Guide - NWS Louisville



Know your county &
Know your location within your county!
Many warnings spread across county lines.

Websites to Monitor Weather:

weather.gov
weather.gov/lmk
spc.noaa.gov
kymesonet.org

Getting Reports to the NWS:

Call:

NWS Spotter line:

(800) 292-5588

Local Emergency Manager

Call 911

Online:

Severe Weather Reporting Form

Email:

lmk.ops@noaa.gov

Social Media:

Twitter: **@NWSLouisville** and #lmkspotter #INwx #kywx

Facebook: **US NWS Louisville KY**

Watch: Conditions are favorable for severe weather

Warning: Severe weather is occurring and lasts 30-45 minutes

Tornado: A violently **rotating** column of air connecting the ground to the base of the storm

Severe Thunderstorm: Storm that produces >58mph wind and/or 1” hail

Flash Flood: Very heavy rain that cause rapidly rising water

Tornado Safety Instructions:

-Abandon mobile homes

-If outside, seek shelter in a ditch

-In a home, put as many walls as possible between you and the outside:

- **-Interior** rooms with **no windows**
- -Closet and bathrooms are ideal
- **-Bottom floor** or **basement**
- -Cover your head and neck

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Beaufort Wind Estimation Chart

Number	Range	Category	Description
0	0 mph	Calm	Smoke rises vertically
1	1-3	Light Air	Wind motion visible in smoke
2	4-7	Light Breeze	Wind felt on skin
3	8-12	Gentle Breeze	Leaves and small twigs in constant motion
4	13-18	Moderate Breeze	Small branches in constant motion
5	19-24	Fresh Breeze	Smaller trees sway
6	25-31	Strong Breeze	Large branches in motion and whistling audible
7	32-38	Near Gale	Whole trees in motion
8	39-46	Gale	Twigs broken and cars veer on road
9	47-54	Severe Gale	Light structural damage
10	55-63	Storm	Trees uprooted and considerable structural damage
11	64-73	Violent Storm	Widespread structural damage
12	74-95	Hurricane	Considerable and widespread structural damage

What Should You Report?

Wind: >50mph or a 9 on the Beaufort Scale
Storm Damage: Large limbs and structural damage
Hail: >1” or Quarter sized
Flooding: Flooded roads and flooding near homes

Time: Time the damage occurred
Location: As specific of a location as possible
Description: Describe the damage (ex. type of trees or structures, large limbs or snapped trunk, direction the damage is lying, etc.)
Images/Videos: Take detailed pictures of damage or images with a reference object nearby for size comparison

Hail Size Chart

0.25”- Pea	0.5”- Dime	0.75”- Penny
1”- Quarter	1.5”- Ping Pong	2”- Lime
2.5”- Tennis Ball	3”- Apple	4”- Softball

